MIKE GOLDFARB
GUIDING YOU HOME

COLDWELL BANKER REALTY



THE ULTIMATE GUIDE TO

# Selling Your Home

## IN LOS ANGELES

How we prepare, price, market and close your sale, and what to expect at every step.


Mike Goldfarb
REALTOR® · COLDWELL BANKER REALTY

310.490.0026
mike@mikegoldfarbproperties.com



*Selling well starts long before the sign goes up.*

INSIDE THIS GUIDE

# Table of Contents


01 **Choose Your Agent** 03

Meet for a listing appointment · Review credentials

02 **Prepare for the Market** 06

Consider repairs · Home prep checklist

03 **Strategic Marketing** 09

Price it right · Photo & video · Staging · The marketing plan

04 **Showing Your Home** 16

Showing strategy · Showing prep checklist

05 **The Closing Process** 18

Going under contract · Milestones to closing



01

CHAPTER ONE

# Choose Your Agent

*Not a decision to take lightly*

## Choosing the agent you'll work alongside to sell your home is one of the biggest decisions in the whole process.

Your agent should have a deep understanding of your goals, your market, and a track record of working diligently on behalf of you, their client.

Credentials are a plus. But what you can't see behind the numbers are the intangibles: always going the extra mile, and genuinely caring about the people you represent.

I look forward to the opportunity of representing you and sharing this milestone with you and your family.

*Mike Goldfarb*



ABOUT ME

# Mike Goldfarb

REALTOR® · COLDWELL BANKER REALTY

I'm an LA native with more than ten years in the Los Angeles real estate market. I know these neighborhoods, how buyers here shop, and what it takes to make a home stand out.

Whether you're buying, selling or investing, I'm here to guide you home.

CREDENTIALS

California licensed real estate agent

Member, National Association of REALTORS®

Member, Greater Los Angeles REALTORS®


CALL 310.490.0026

EMAIL mike@mikegoldfarbproperties.com

INSTA @mike.goldfarb


## What you can *expect* working with me

### I'm Curious

I want a clear understanding of your goals, who you are, and what your home means to you.

### I'm Committed

I bring my A-game to every transaction and push for the best possible outcome.

### I'm Proactive

I stay a step ahead, spotting roadblocks early and finding creative ways around them.

### I'm Personal

I build real relationships and treat clients like family. That's what leads to the best results.

IN THEIR WORDS

# What Clients Are Saying



★★★★★

Mike brought a level of strategy, communication and hustle that genuinely set our sale apart from other homes sitting on the market. He was proactive every step of the way, marketed the property creatively, and made us feel confident and supported.

AMY AND MATT

★★★★★

Working with Mike was an outstanding experience from start to finish. He guided us through the sale with expertise and care, helped us position it strategically, and secured an accepted offer in just 14 days. We couldn't have asked for a better partner.

BEVERLY AND CHRIS





★★★★★

Working with Mike to sell our home was a really special experience. His knowledge of the Los Angeles market and his ability to navigate the sale made a huge difference in achieving a strong outcome. I felt like I was in very good hands.

BARRY AND DONNA




# Prepare for the Market

## *Consider home repairs*

Buyers gravitate toward a turnkey home they can move right into. Skipped repairs and maintenance can be a major turn-off and stall your sale.

Think about high-impact updates: decluttering and depersonalizing, a fresh coat of paint, pressure washing, and sprucing up the curb appeal.

Putting in the legwork now does two things. It lifts your sale price, and it keeps the process moving quickly once a buyer shows interest.

Use the checklist on the next two pages and walk through your home room by room as if you were the buyer. Keep their perspective in mind as you decide what to fix.

CHECKLIST

# Listing Preparation Checklist

Walk through your home room by room as if you were a buyer. Check what needs attention, then check it off once it's done. A pre-listing inspection can tell you if anything needs repair.

## GENERAL

| | TO DO | DONE |
|---|---|---|
| Light fixtures | ☐ | ☐ |
| Light bulbs | ☐ | ☐ |
| Carpets | ☐ | ☐ |
| Windows | ☐ | ☐ |
| Cabinets | ☐ | ☐ |
| Sinks and faucets | ☐ | ☐ |
| Paint | ☐ | ☐ |
| HVAC | ☐ | ☐ |
| Flooring | ☐ | ☐ |
| Doors and trim | ☐ | ☐ |
| Wallpaper | ☐ | ☐ |
| Hardware | ☐ | ☐ |
| Carbon monoxide detector | ☐ | ☐ |
| Smoke detector | ☐ | ☐ |

## KITCHEN

| | TO DO | DONE |
|---|---|---|
| Clear and clean counters | ☐ | ☐ |
| Clean backsplash | ☐ | ☐ |
| Clean appliances inside and out | ☐ | ☐ |
| Organize drawers, cabinets and pantry | ☐ | ☐ |
| Clean floors | ☐ | ☐ |
| Clean sink and disposal | ☐ | ☐ |

## BATHROOMS

| | TO DO | DONE |
|---|---|---|
| Dust and clean all surfaces | ☐ | ☐ |
| Clear countertops and drawers | ☐ | ☐ |
| Fold towels | ☐ | ☐ |
| Tidy cabinets, remove extra toiletries | ☐ | ☐ |
| Clean or replace shower curtains | ☐ | ☐ |
| Clean any mildew | ☐ | ☐ |

## LIVING & DINING

| | TO DO | DONE |
|---|---|---|
| Remove clutter and personal items | ☐ | ☐ |
| Stage with pillows and throws | ☐ | ☐ |
| Dust and clean surfaces and fixtures | ☐ | ☐ |
| Keep tables clear | ☐ | ☐ |

## BEDROOMS

| | TO DO | DONE |
|---|---|---|
| Remove clutter and personal items | ☐ | ☐ |
| Clean out and organize closets | ☐ | ☐ |
| Repair any wall damage | ☐ | ☐ |
| Keep closets closed for showings | ☐ | ☐ |
| Make beds before showings | ☐ | ☐ |

## EXTERIOR

| | TO DO | DONE |
|---|---|---|
| Pressure wash concrete and driveway | ☐ | ☐ |
| Clean or repaint doors | ☐ | ☐ |
| Repaint trim | ☐ | ☐ |
| Wash windows | ☐ | ☐ |
| Sweep walkways and patios | ☐ | ☐ |
| Trim hedges | ☐ | ☐ |
| Mow lawn | ☐ | ☐ |
| Weed and mulch | ☐ | ☐ |
| Arrange outdoor furniture | ☐ | ☐ |
| Repair fence | ☐ | ☐ |
| Replace any rotten wood | ☐ | ☐ |
| Pool and spa clean and working | ☐ | ☐ |

*"Buyers decide in the first 8 seconds of seeing a home if they're interested in buying it. Get out of your car, walk in their shoes and see what they see within the first 8 seconds."*

BARBARA CORCORAN



03

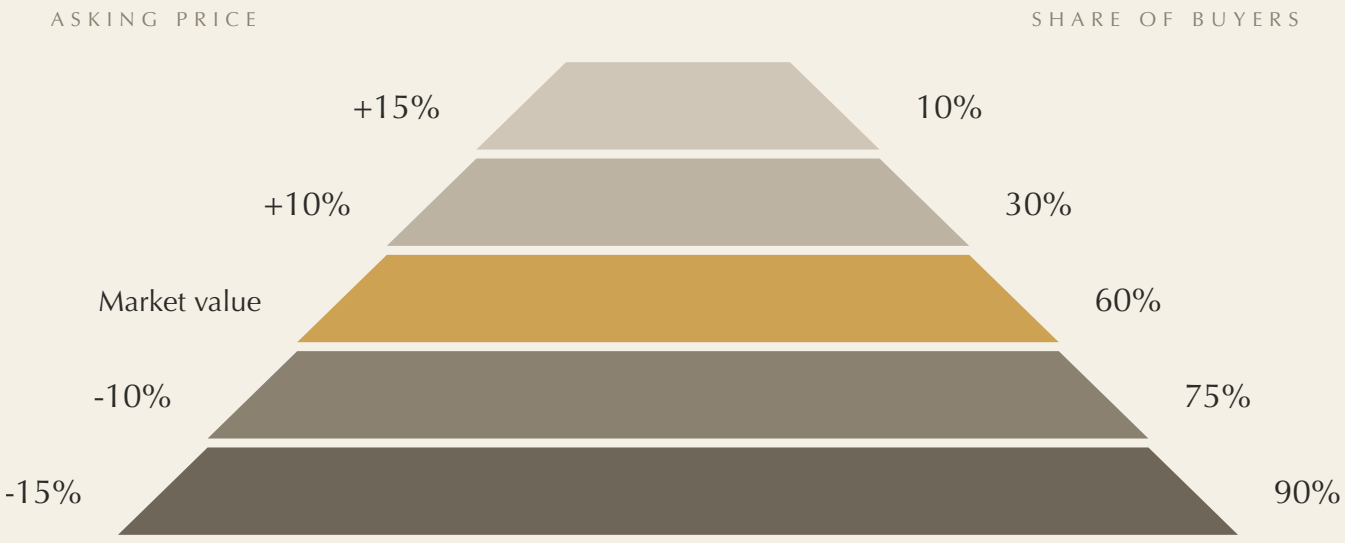
CHAPTER THREE

# Strategic Marketing

## *Pricing your home*

Here's something that may surprise you: homes priced right from the start usually sell for more in the end.

Price too high and the home sits. The longer it sits, the fewer buyers come to see it. Interest peaks in the first days on the market, so getting the price right at launch is everything.



PRICING STRATEGY

# Pricing It Right

Where you price determines who shows up. Here's how each approach tends to play out.

BELOW MARKET

## Built for a bidding war

+ High interest and a quick sale
+ Multiple offers, possibly above asking
– Some risk of selling for less

AT MARKET VALUE

## The sweet spot

+ Buyers and agents recognize a fair price
+ Fewer appraisal issues
+ Shows up in more of the right buyer searches

OVER MARKET

## The slow road

– Takes longer to sell
– The longer it sits, the less appealing it looks
– May not appraise, sending you back to negotiations

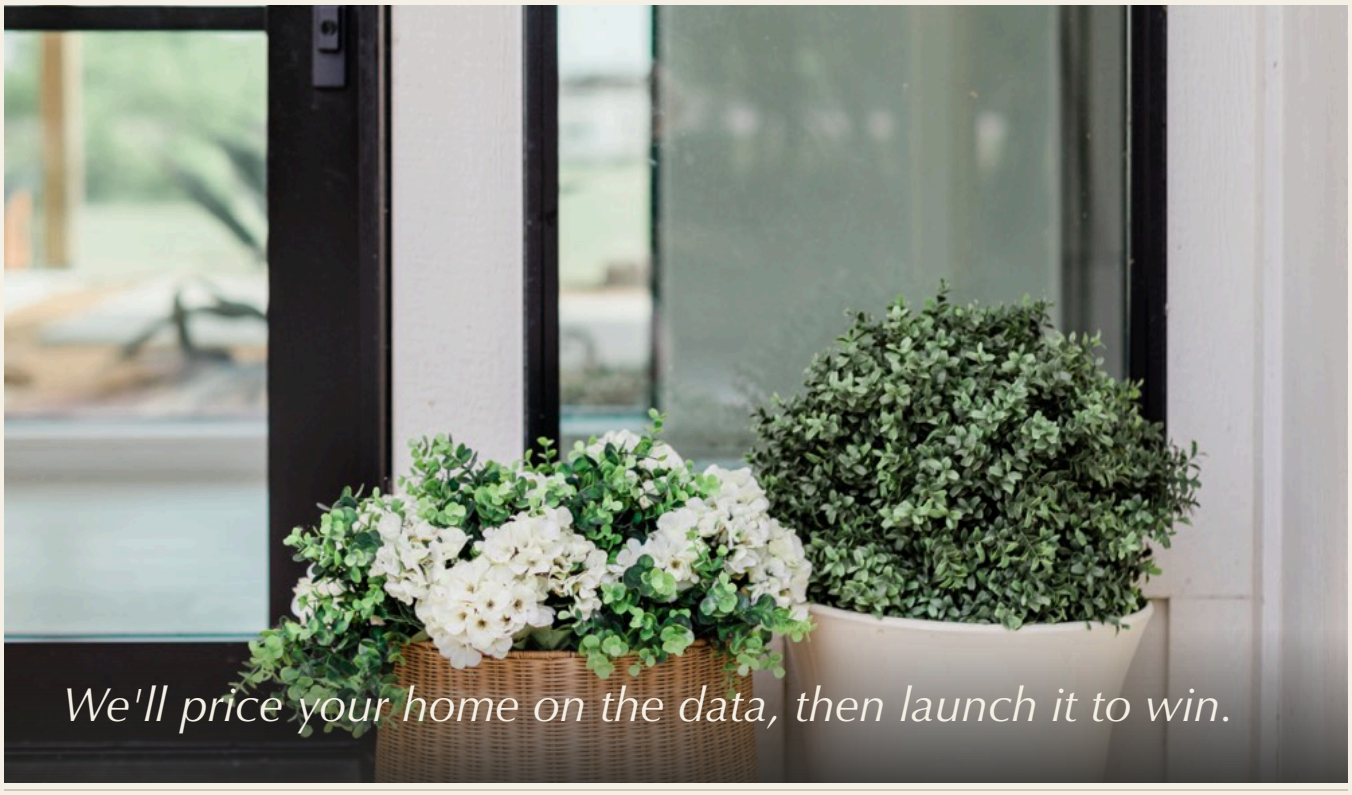


PHOTO & VIDEO

# Why Listing Photos Matter

Your photos decide whether a buyer books a showing. That's why I work with top LA real estate photographers and videographers to capture your home in its best light, at no cost to you.







FROM MY PREVIOUS LISTINGS

## What's included in my marketing plan

- Featured on the Coldwell Banker website
- Featured on mikegoldfarbproperties.com
- Social media marketing campaigns
- Virtual tours
- Exclusive sneak peeks
- Open houses
- Broker previews
- Digital and print flyers
- Postcards
- Professional photography, including drone and twilight
- Professional videography
- Yard sign lead capture
- Outreach to surrounding neighbors

MARKETING

# Modern Agent Marketing Strategy

## Insta-Showcases

Your home's story deserves to be told. Instagram posts and behind-the-scenes tours highlight its best features and build a personal connection with buyers.

## SEO-Driven Strategy

Behind the scenes, I optimize your listing's online presence so it ranks well in search and reaches buyers before they even know they're looking.

## Hollywood-Level Home Tours

Think of it as your home's movie debut. Cinematic video tells the story of your property and engages buyers emotionally and visually.

## Scroll-Stopping Visuals & Copy

Every post, video and listing is crafted to travel. Strong visuals and storytelling copy make your home the main character.

OUR REACH

| 5k+ | 1k+ | 500k+ | 20k+ |
|---|---|---|---|
| SUBSCRIBERS + FOLLOWERS | EMAIL SUBSCRIBERS | MONTHLY IMPRESSIONS | MONTHLY ENGAGEMENTS |

MARKETING CASE STUDY

# 2144 N. Pepper St.

*The key strategies*

## Content creation

A series of polished posts with professional photos, video and drone footage highlighting the architecture and setting.

## Distribution

The video ran on YouTube, Instagram and Facebook, and was embedded in the listing and email campaigns.

## Targeted advertising

Paid ads with demographic and interest targeting reached buyers who matched the likely profile.

## Custom email blasts

Targeted campaigns to a curated list of buyers and agents featuring the home, the video and open house dates.

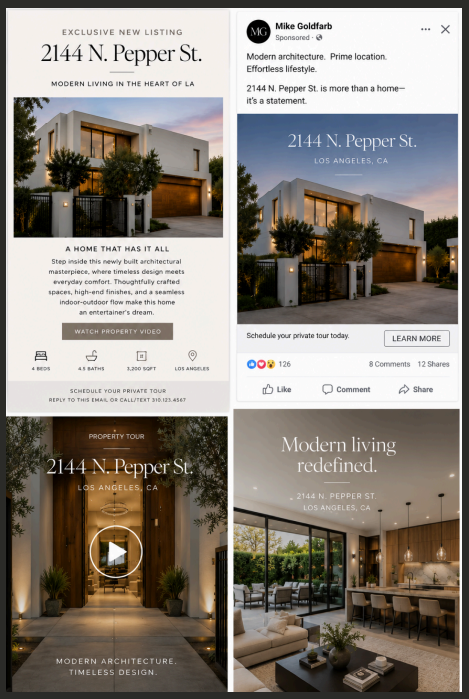
## Production

A high-definition walkthrough video showcasing key selling points and the lifestyle of the neighborhood.

## Follow-up sequences

A series of follow-up emails kept interested buyers engaged with more about the property and community.

SAMPLE ASSETS



MARKETING CASE STUDY

# The Results

**20k+**

Targeted users reached by the social campaign

**25%**

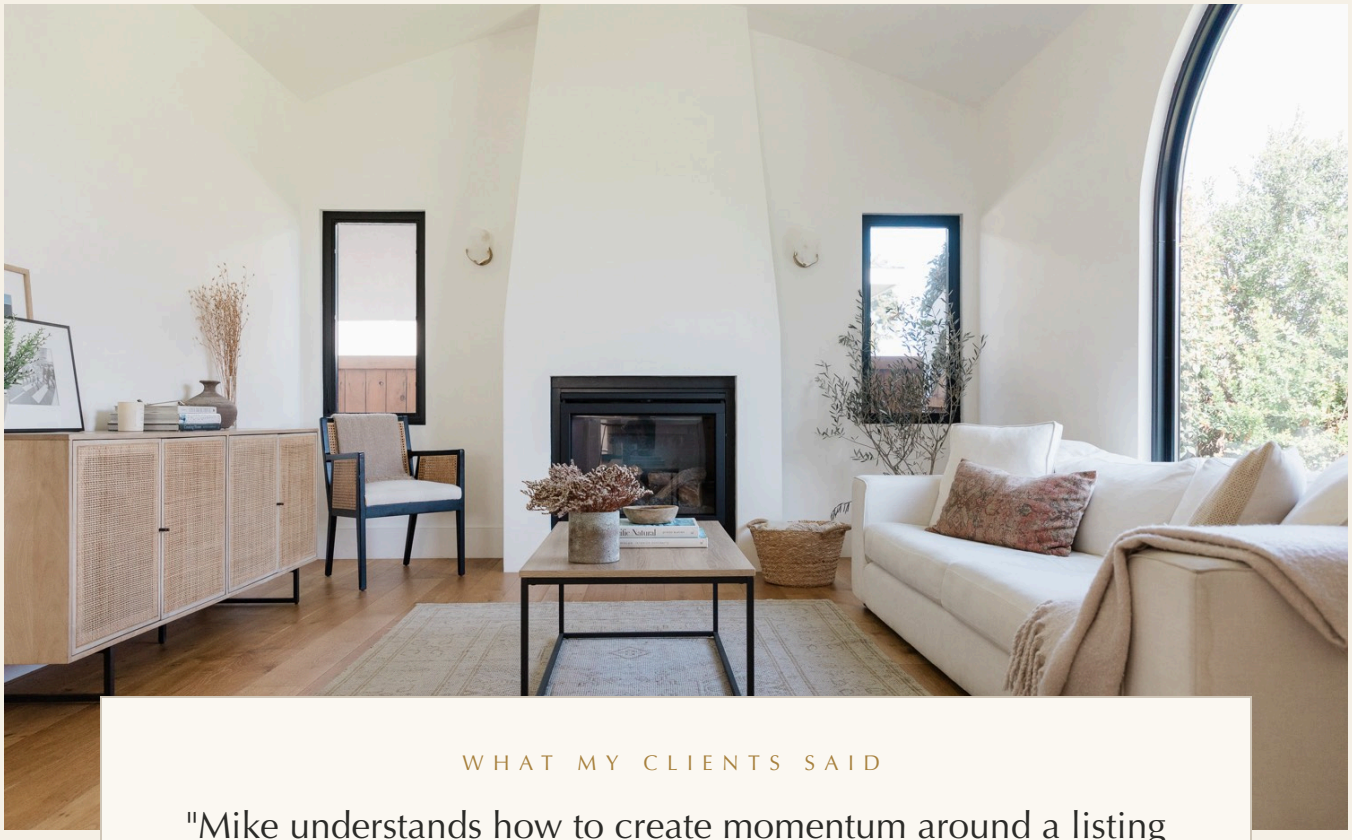
Engagement rate across ads and organic posts

**50**

High-quality leads, far more than traditional marketing

**14**

Days to an accepted offer at 100% of asking



WHAT MY CLIENTS SAID

"Mike understands how to create momentum around a listing and position a home in a way that generates real interest. His approach felt modern, proactive and tailored to our property. We truly felt like we had someone advocating for our best outcome every single day."




# Staged to Sell

Staging goes beyond looks. It creates an experience that lets buyers picture their lives unfolding in your home.

When first impressions are everything, a well-staged home stands out as inviting and memorable, and it tends to sell faster and for more.

The best part? Staging usually costs less than the first price drop you'd face if the home lingers on the market.

It's a smart, strategic move with proven results.

**83%**

of buyers' agents say staging makes it easier for buyers to picture the property as their future home.

NATIONAL ASSOCIATION OF REALTORS®

**73%**

less time on the market for professionally staged homes compared with homes that weren't staged.

REAL ESTATE STAGING ASSOCIATION



04

CHAPTER FOUR

# Showing Your Home

## *It's showing time*

Together we'll set the days and hours that work for showings. Here's how it works:

- **Homes show best without the owner**
  If you can't be away, we'll create the best experience for buyers that still fits your life.
- **Secure electronic lockbox**
  A lockbox holds a set of keys, and I'm notified every time it opens. No one enters without my knowledge.
- **Feedback after every showing**
  I'll share what buyers and their agents said, so we can adjust if needed.
- **Prep before each showing**
  Use the checklist on the next page to set the best atmosphere for buyers.



CHECKLIST

# Showing Prep Checklist

- [ ] Create a welcoming entry: sweep the porch, clean the door, add a mat or wreath.
- [ ] Remove personal items, paperwork, extra furniture and clutter.
- [ ] Make sure there are no odors, but go easy on air fresheners. Open windows ahead of time.
- [ ] Turn on the lights and open the curtains for natural light.
- [ ] Close toilet seats and shower curtains. Put out fresh, crisp linens.
- [ ] Arrange furniture for a sense of space and flow.
- [ ] Take pets out during showings and tidy any pet messes.
- [ ] Add fresh flowers or a bowl of fruit for a welcoming touch.
- [ ] Set the thermostat to a comfortable temperature well before buyers arrive.



05

CHAPTER FIVE

# The Closing Process

## *From accepted offer to closing day*

The closing process begins once we accept an offer. Here are the milestones to expect:

- **Escrow opens**

  The buyer places an earnest money deposit with escrow, a neutral third party that holds funds until closing.

- **Loan approval & appraisal**

  The lender confirms the buyer's financing and that the value supports the price. These are often contingencies.

- **Closing day**

  The buyer signs, funds and receives the keys. The deed records and your proceeds are released to you.

- **Buyer's due diligence**

  Inspections and other investigations confirm the home's condition matches the buyer's expectations.

- **Final walk-through**

  Just before closing, the buyer confirms the home is in the agreed-upon condition.

STRATEGY

# Why Offering Buyer Agent Compensation Is a Smart Move

01

## Expands your visibility

Offering compensation makes your listing more appealing to buyers' agents, which means more showings and more chances for offers.

02

## Smoother transactions

It encourages cooperation between agents, leading to smoother negotiations and a more efficient sale.

03

## Better sale outcomes

With more exposure and more motivated agents, homes offering compensation often sell faster and for better prices.

04

## Signals a professional approach

It shows a commitment to a fair, efficient process and sets a positive tone for the whole transaction.



*Commissions are fully negotiable and not set by law. Whether and how much to offer is always your decision.*



# Next Steps

Getting started is simple. Once we agree on a price and sign a few documents, your home can be on the market in as little as 48 hours. Selling your home is a big deal, and I'm honored to be considered for the job.

*Mike Goldfarb*


CALL OR TEXT
310.490.0026

EMAIL
mike@mikegoldfarbproperties.com

WEB
mikegoldfarbproperties.com


MIKE GOLDFARB
GUIDING YOU HOME

COLDWELL BANKER | REALTY


Mike Goldfarb | REALTOR® | Coldwell Banker Realty | DRE #02231446. This guide is general information, not legal, tax or financial advice. Results from past listings don't guarantee future results. Commissions are negotiable. Equal Housing Opportunity.